

BIHAR FLOOD RELIEF FUND

KOSI FLOODS 2008

Safe and SOUND



CARE TODAY joins hands with other NGOs to give flood victims a brighter future



SOS CHILDREN'S VILLAGES OF INDIA

CHILDREN GOING TO SCHOOL IN NEW UNIFORMS

The breaking of the Kosi embankment on August 18, 2008, and the devastating floods that followed left millions homeless. Several children who lost their family members in this catastrophe are still haunted by the devastation. To help those ravaged by the floods, CARE TODAY set up the Bihar Flood Relief Fund which raised Rs 1.43 crore for relief and rehabilitation work in the affected areas.

With the support of Bihar Development Trust, an NGO, CARE TODAY rushed to support the needy villagers in the Nawgachia subdivision of Bhagalpur district. CARE TODAY has also provided a grant of Rs 59.1 lakh to the Kutch Navnirman Abhiyan to construct 89 houses at Puraini village in Birpur block of Supaul district. To help orphaned children in Jorgama village, CARE TODAY is supporting the SOS Children's Villages of India with a two-year grant of Rs 25.20 lakh. The SOS Children's Villages of India has identified 150 affected children from 51 families and, through its Family Strengthening Programme (FSP), aims to assist families in providing adequate care—food, clothes, health and education and shelter—for these children, making them less vulnerable to the potential risk of trafficking.

As a part of the FSP, the SOS Children's Villages has constructed an activity centre in the village. Built with hay and clay on a plot of land donated by a community

member, it is a centre of attraction not just for children but also for adults. While children come to play and learn, villagers also benefit from the literacy drive run by the centre. The centre's teaching programme imparts non-formal education to children and has so far succeeded in sending 18 of them to school. As part of the FSP, these children are given additional nutritional support, either through the anganwadis or directly through their families.

In order to strengthen the affected families, a systematic survey was done and so far nine families were provided with livelihood support. This resulted in a substantial rise in their income, from Rs 500 to Rs 750 per month. Nineteen women from 51 families are also part of Self Help Groups (SHGs) formed to encourage saving. As part of the project run by the SOS Children's Villages, a medical officer visits the village twice a month and a family health card is maintained. The families are covered by health insurance worth Rs 30,000 to support hospitalisation expenses and an allowance of Rs 50 per day if the earning member of the family is admitted to the hospital for more than seven days.

Thus, by focusing on the overall development of the families, this project run by CARE TODAY and the SOS Children's Villages of India is providing adequate protection to the children and securing their future.